



4orm Founder Vision and North Star

The founder story, purpose and permanent North Star behind 4orm.

Founder statement

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4orm Finance · Confidential

Chad R. Johnston, Founder and Chief Executive, 4orm Finance

NORTH STAR

Understanding before the decision. Evidence after it.

PEOPLE. TRUST. CLEAR OUTCOMES.

The best time to manage risk is before the event.

4orm was shaped by two founders whose experience taught them to think about risk before something goes wrong.

Chad's early career was spent in oil and gas and critical life-safety environments, where the potential consequences of inadequate planning, controls or understanding could be immediate and severe. Before work began, hazards had to be identified, controls and mitigations put in place, responsibilities understood and the people involved clear on the conditions around them. The principle was simple: the best time to manage risk is before the event, not after it.

That mindset carried forward as both founders spent years working with people in retail trading and investing, supporting thousands of individuals through financial decisions, uncertainty, risk and loss. They learned that better outcomes often begin with better questions, helping people slow down, explore what they do not know, understand the risks and make more informed decisions before acting.

Much of financial protection remains reactive.

That experience became especially important in fraud prevention. Through a hands-on vetting process, Chad helped identify risks before money moved, contributing to more than **\$25 million** in potential losses being avoided. He also worked directly with a community of people affected by fraudulent activity where approximately **\$10.5 million** had already been lost.

Seeing both sides, losses that had already happened and losses that could still be prevented, reinforced the same lesson learned in critical-safety environments years earlier. Much of financial protection remains reactive. 4orm was built around a different idea: bring proactive thinking into the financial decision itself. Give people the tools, resources, education and space to ask better questions, understand themselves, recognize risk and explore a decision before committing. At the same time, give the businesses serving them a better understanding of the person and a clear record of what was known, explained, considered and agreed.

The industries are different. The principle is the same.

Understand first, identify risk early, put the right information and controls in place, make the decision with greater clarity and preserve the evidence of what happened.

MISSION

Give people the tools, resources and education to make better financial decisions, helping them plan for the long term, recognize and avoid unnecessary risks, and build sustainable, prosperous lives for generations to come.

For the businesses serving them, our mission also means creating a clearer understanding of the person and a durable record of what was known, explained, considered and agreed.

4orming trust into financial decisions.

People · Trust · Clear Outcomes